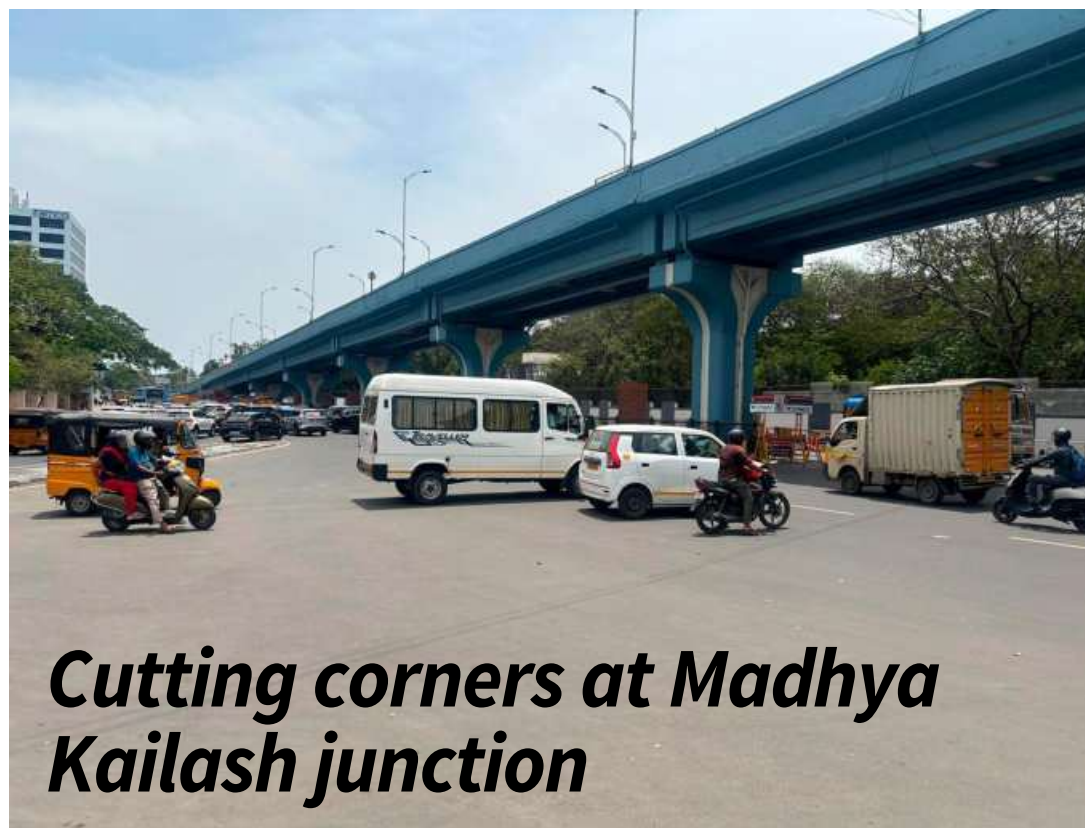


IT CORRIDOR

Adyar » Kanathur » Kelambakkam » Navalur » Semmencherry » Thoraipakkam » Velachery » IIT Madras » Kandanchavadi » Kottivakkam

Neelankarai » Sholinganallur » Thiruvannamiyur » Vijaya Nagar » Indira Nagar » Karapakkam » Kotturpuram » Padur » Thalambur » Pallikaralai



Cutting corners at Madhya Kailash junction

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

At Madhya Kailash junction where, Sardar Patel Road meets, there is a need to monitor traffic movement with peeled eyes.

Motorists from the IT Corridor, proceeding towards Canal Bank Road and Gandhi Nagar in Adyar, should take a U-turn on Sardar Patel Road, not far from Gandhi Mandapam Road.

But motorists navigate along the turning point (from Rajiv Gandhi Salai to Sardar Patel Road), come all of a sudden and startle motorists on Sardar Patel Road from Gandhi Nagar and Kasurba Nagar.

Motorists coming from OMR drive through the old bus stop area (paved) or take a U-turn at the end of the area.

M. Balaji, a motorist, says, "These motorists drive at a fast clip disrupting the traffic flow and forcing their counterparts from Adyar to slam on their brakes. At times, the threat of multiple collisions is real. The absence of traffic personnel at this spot is a major concern."

Motorists from the IT Corridor halt on the road, forcing their counterparts from Adyar to swerve left and negotiate their way around the vehicles facing them. Here, a U-turn is allowed for motorists from Little Mount and Kotturpuram, as the intensity

of vehicular traffic from there is higher compared to the one from the Adyar region.

Motorists from Adyar join them (counterparts navigating from OMR) taking a U-turn, disrupting the traffic flow.

S. Alex, a motorist, says, "When a good number of motorists from Adyar and OMR negotiate this section in this manner, it becomes difficult for motorists from Little Mount and Kotturpuram to take a U-turn. Motorists from Adyar and OMR drive fast. At the last minute, they swerve right and, at times, knock those from Little Mount taking a U-turn. These motorists cut off traffic towards Gandhi Nagar while making a U-turn."



Motorists from the IT Corridor disrupt the traffic flow on Sardar Patel Road to go to Canal Bank Road and Gandhi Nagar in Adyar.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A message flapping high



A staggeringly huge number of organisations united by their interest in conservation of natural habitats organised a protest march at Besant Nagar Beach on July 25, highlighting the destruction of wetlands in south Chennai.

One of the salient features of the march was the eye-catching props used by the protestors. The props included a life-size representation of a flamingo demanding that people stay off its turf. Others included images of fish that people were wearing while holding placards.

Text: & photo: C. Namachivayam

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Communities on OMR receiving free composters

PLAN Foundation is offering aerobins to bulk waste generators to encourage in situ composting. Besides gated communities, educational institutions and companies are covered by this initiative

LIFFY THOMAS

In parts of Rajiv Gandhi Salai, gated communities that take source segregation seriously have found an ally. PLAN Foundation, a Mumbai-based NGO working with communities on climate and waste solutions, is encouraging in situ composting. And it walks the talk by establishing free in-house composting facilities for bulk waste generators. Going on steam in February, the exercise has benefitted gated communities in Kelambakkam, Padur and Kazhipattur. Educational institutions and companies also come under the ambit of this initiative.

Under SORT (Segregation of Waste for Recycling and Treatment), a flagship initiative of Swarn Lata Motherson Trust and PLAN Foundation, community composters called 'aerobins' are being given to educational institutions, gated communities and companies that fall under the category of bulk waste generators.

To get aerobins, the community must be following the practice of only collecting segregated waste from residents or promise to start doing it with a stern resolve. The community must have an active housekeeping team that is ready to oversee functioning of aerobins.

The NGO first does an audit of the community's waste management studying the amount of biodegradable and non-biodegradable matter that it generates and through a baseline survey understands the gaps. An average of six bins are given to most bulk waste generators, each measuring 400 litres.

All stakeholders including housekeeping staff and residents are trained in the process and expectations are set for them. "Only after they are ready to meet the conditions laid down by us do we enter into an agreement with the community," says Rasiga Selvaganesan, assistant manager-project, PLAN Foundation.

For six months, the Foundation handholds the community in many ways including maintaining an inventory, making them use their own garden litter instead of saw dust to absorb excess moisture from the bins and supporting them to get the harvest.

Rasiga says aerobins are a patented technology from Australia



The 'harvest' is ready at Marg Pushkara and (right) the aerobins



and they have been promoting this idea for the last three years as it does not take much space, does not exude an odour and follows aerobic composting.

The Foundation had made headway implementing a similar model in Kovalam Panchayat.

32 and counting

Since February 2026, when the second phase of this project was initiated for bulk waste generators in Thiruporur, OMR and parts of

Tambaram, the team has reached out to 120 communities. "Thirty two have signed an official agreement that spells out what is expected of the RWA and the Foundations," says Rasiga.

For the team, persuading bulk waste generators to invest in on-site composting is not easy even though the aerobins are given at no cost. Many tell the team upfront that ensuring compliance from the majority of residents is not easy.

Dropout rate

Niraj Singh, senior manager, SORT project, says there have been many instances of communities losing interest either because of a change of guard or for other reasons. "We try persuasion with the new committee. If that falls, in a worst case scenario, we will lift the aerobins and move to other localities that could benefit from receiving composters. That has happened at two to three communities in Kovalam. So, while

onboarding RWAs, this clause is mentioned," says Niraj, adding "We see a dropout rate of 10% in SORT."

On OMR, many eco-conscious volunteers driving green initiatives in gated communities are excited that communities that have shied away from adopting on-site composting due to the cost factor would want to try it out as much of the investment is borne by the Foundation. There are some others who have received the aerobins but waiting to see the fruits of the exercise. Some communities such as Jain Inseli Park in Padur, which has stopped giving out the wet waste to a vendor, are planning to source more aerobins. The bins that are priced at around ₹24,000 are procured for them at a discounted rate by PLAN Foundation.

Those keen on inviting the team for a demo can email rasiga.s@plan-foundation.in

Community takes baby steps in managing waste purposefully

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Four months ago, Pushkara Flat Owners Association at Kazhipattur in Tiruporur Taluk decided to overhaul its waste management system thanks to the nudge from PLAN Foundation and the interest by the management committee members to make a small difference in the neighbourhood.

Over the years, Marg Pushkara, a gated community with 131 flats, had no good systems in place to manage the community's waste. Close to 16 bins were kept at a common area where residents had to come on their own to dispose of the waste, to be collected by a vendor twice or thrice a week.

Before getting into a formal agreement with the Foundation, the Association started enforcing source segregation of waste with



The housekeeping staff at Marg Pushkara in Kazhipattur

awareness messages, constant communication and a third eye to keep a watch on those not

dropping segregated waste.

"We invested in a CCTV camera, put up flex boards at the gar-

bage collection point mentioning that a fine would be collected from those not following waste management rules," says S. Vasudevan, secretary, Pushkara Flat Owners Association.

This served as a deterrent for residents, says members.

For better compliance, they recently introduced door-to-door collection of waste, got garbage trolleys customised from a store in Broadway and hired additional manpower to manage the aerobins. "Compliance has improved drastically in these months and we have also got two harvests from the aerobins," says Vasudevan, adding that 52 kilos of manure they have got so far.

The Association has also streamlined collection of other non-biodegradable waste. The amount collected by selling recyclable waste is giving to the housekeeping team.

Metro Rail work on major corridors in Mylapore has cast a shadow on C.P. Koil Street with its goldsmiths, and here is how these traditional craftspersons are ensuring the sparkle is not lost despite poor access to their doorsteps

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Chengazhuneer Pillaiyar Koil Street off North Mada Street in Mylapore can be missed by footwear-clad hooves other than those heading to it aware of what it has to offer, a standout craftsmanship nestling quietly inside. Narrow and hemmed in by non-decrepit buildings, it slips past the eye unless one has known it for what it is: the bling street in these parts. In terms of numbers, both of shops and transactions, C.P. Koil Street is no patch on Edapalayam Street, which winds like a necklace between NSC Bose Road in George Town and Walltax Road in Park Town. While Edapalayam Street is the undisputed capital for gold and other precious metal jewellery-making and testing in Chennai, C.P. Koil Street could be placed in a “family” that includes gold jewellery-making enclaves in T. Nagar and Purasawalkam.

The description of a lane fitting it better than that of a street, C.P. Koil Street (the quickly recognised contraction) is lined with shops of gold-and-other-precious-metal jewellery-making craftspersons strategically interspersed with those selling jewellery. There are flower vendors, and shops selling temple-related items at C.P. Koil Street sketching the classic image of a street running close to a famous temple (in this case, Kapaleeswarar temple), but the one trait that overrides everything else is that of a turf for craftspersons adept at shaping precious metal into wearables. These craftspersons, some of whom also work with silver and zari saris that have gold and silver threads woven into them, draw upon the trust built patiently over generations. At Santhosh Thanga Maligai, the owner M. Padmanabhan is carrying forward a family business that had its genesis on North Mada Street where his grandfather operated for nearly 50 years. In its current location at C.P. Koil Street, the business has weathered 40 summers. And if one does a simple addition math, there is an unmistakable and majestic hoariness to the enterprise. This account of a skill passed down generations is a recurring feature, the story reappearing at different addresses across C.P. Koil Street’s storefront.

A bling street behind barricades

This business cannot get any more family-oriented than it is. It could not be put more lucidly than how Karthik Gopal of Sagunthala Testing on C.P. Koil Street does. “It is a family business started by my grandfather Venkatesh,” and on who has been running it now, Karthik rattles off a list: “My father, me, my uncle, my aunt, my mother, my cousins, my niece... everyone” And that certainly is pretty much everyone in the family.

Just as craftsmanship and ownership are passed down the generations, on the other side of the counter, customer loyalty also follows an unbroken line of continuity, generations of a family getting gold jewellery done at a shop

whose work ethics they trust. This trust is coming in handy as these craftspersons are battling challenges arising from a mammoth civic work just beyond C.P. Koil Street’s doorsteps.

Finding itself in the long shadows of Metro rail work all around it, C.P. Koil Street might be a little less hoofed now, but the adverse situation has not significantly detracted from its glitter. The trust factor carries the day for these craftspersons as floating customers have dwindled on account of access unwittingly restricted by Metro rail work on main corridors in Mylapore, examples being Kutchery Road, Luz Church Road and RK Mutt Road.

“Now, almost all roads leading to the street have been affected by Metro rail work. Our regular customers still return because they know us,” says Karthik, noting that accessibility as a whole has been a difficult hurdle to bypass. Years of dedication and craftsmanship have earned them a loyal customer base. However, reputation alone cannot replace the steady stream of first-time visitors the place once enjoyed. “Seven years ago, there was much more footfall,” Karthik recalls. Being overly dependent on your established customer base with little scope for new customers swelling it can bring about a frustrating clinginess and a tendency to want to play Aladdin’s servile genie to those loyal customers from the past. Padmanabhan says his shop is open all days of the week, from 10.30 a.m. to 8.30 p.m.; and they close for work only on two festival days in a year. This challenge plonks alongside others faced by all goldsmiths, particularly those in south India, in Karthik’s view. While technology would have brought a cutting edge of accuracy and speed to the goldsmith’s job, Karthik notes, customers still prefer the sight of a goldsmith seated in front of them and testing and assessing the precious

In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at how a narrow, hidden street associated with a form of time-tested craftsmanship is holding on to its legacy against the backdrop of a civic work that has disrupted commerce in the region

metal. It is down to trust issues, he points out. Laser technology makes jewellery-making swift, but too many people cannot be allowed to stay around lest there could be spread of dust. Those who work with this technology are in the right gear for it. The challenge lies in making the process effective through technology and at the same time making it reassuringly visible for the customer.

A picture of sameness

“The street has not changed much,” says Karthik. Padmanabhan echoes that sentiment in a tone that rings wistful. “There has been no development. The street remains the same, and its narrowness leaves little scope for change,” says Padmanabhan. And perhaps that is what makes the present struggle so striking and relevant. The businesses remain where they started and the community they created continues to seek them. It is the journey moving forward that has become increasingly difficult for them. Preserving the place’s commercial character also means preserving the ease with which people, the outsiders, can be a part of it. And at present, that is a challenge.



A small number of apartment communities in Chennai now offer an impressive 1:1 EV charger-to-parking ratio thanks to developers future-focussed in their thinking. Even these developers admit they are on a learning curve, trying to grapple with technology to make their offering even more meaningful

Towards a fully 'charged up' parking space

LIFFY THOMAS

When a large apartment complex goes big on EV adoption, providing a dedicated charging point at every parking slot, the move will have far-reaching benefits. For one, it would give impetus to the Tamil Nadu government's October 2025 mandate requiring charging point for every individual car and two-wheeler parking space in residential buildings.

Here are two builders who saw the need for personalised charging points even before the State Government came up with this mandate.

In 2022-23, Radiance Group announced launch of the 234-unit Radiance Majestic in Valasaravakkam with one feature embossed: a one-to-one charger to parking ratio. Eight months ago when residents started occupying the flats, they were happy the builder had made good the promise.

The apartment complex has 10-15 EV owners who make the most of the single phase EV charging point that

delivers 7.4 kW of power when connected to their individual meter. This infrastructure is likely to get more residents to switch to an EV.

The builder is modest to admit they still have some ground to cover.

"We were inspired by projects in Pune and Mumbai to adopt the same in Chennai, but we are still learning as those owning a high end car want a fast charger but we have only provided a neutral charger. As this technology is still evolving, there is a lot that we need to analyse and factor in as more owners bring home an EV," says Gnana Murugan of Radiance Group.

With individual EV plug point at every parking spot, Lancor Infynys, a 290-flat gated community in Keelakattalai has a story of how the teething trouble was overcome. The irritants, which

included lack of output from the charging point, app not getting connected and iPhone not getting synced, were addressed over a period of time. "With technology do expect some issues but it is extremely easy and convenient to charge at your convenience from your own space," says Vinoth Kumar, who owns an electric two-wheeler.

He shifted from a large apartment complex in Pallikaranai to Keelakattalai a year ago to avail this facility. "My previous apartment did not have even a common charging point, so I used to go to public charging stations or borrow from other EV owners who had connected it from their power box," says Vinoth.

Those working in the EV charging network say it is way easier for an upcoming project to provide owners with the basic infrastructure at their parking lot by focusing on proper earthing and electric load capacity than initiating the work in existing apartments.

Nethaji M, senior manager, charging infrastructure at Bolt.Earth, an EV charging network, says all that we ask developers is provide the cabling work by connecting every parking lot

with the resident's individual meter. The charging kit varies from vehicle to vehicle and is provided when the person buys

the EV which can be fitted to the plug point.

"3.3 kW is the basic requirement that we recommend for an individual parking lot, but as the number of EV users increases in a community the extra load must also be planned by coordinating with the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board," says Nethaji.

CREDAI's stand

Confederation of Real Estate Developers Association of India - Chennai had represented to the Additional Chief Secretary, Housing and Urban Development Department, Government of Tamil Nadu that one-to-one charger-to-parking ratio may be "technically unnecessary, financially burdensome, and operationally impractical, especially in large residential developments."

Currently, 7 kW AC home charger has been used as the ba-

sis for EVs priced below ₹20 lakh. With the market fast moving towards 11 kW AC chargers, transitioning from 7 kW to 11 kW would reduce charging times by nearly 35%, sharply improving utilisation efficiency. If 11 kW becomes the norm, the current requirement of having a dedicated charger for every parking slot would result in an overcapacity, nearly 18 times higher, rendering the infrastructure severely underutilised, says CREDAI in their representation. Developers feel rapid technological advancements will outdate today's chargers. EV charging cables, often 30-40 mm in diameter, pose major challenges when routing hundreds of lines across basements and high-rise structures. The cumulative cable volume, ducting requirements, and heat considerations make one-to-one provisioning technically unviable.

A green upgrade, slow and steady

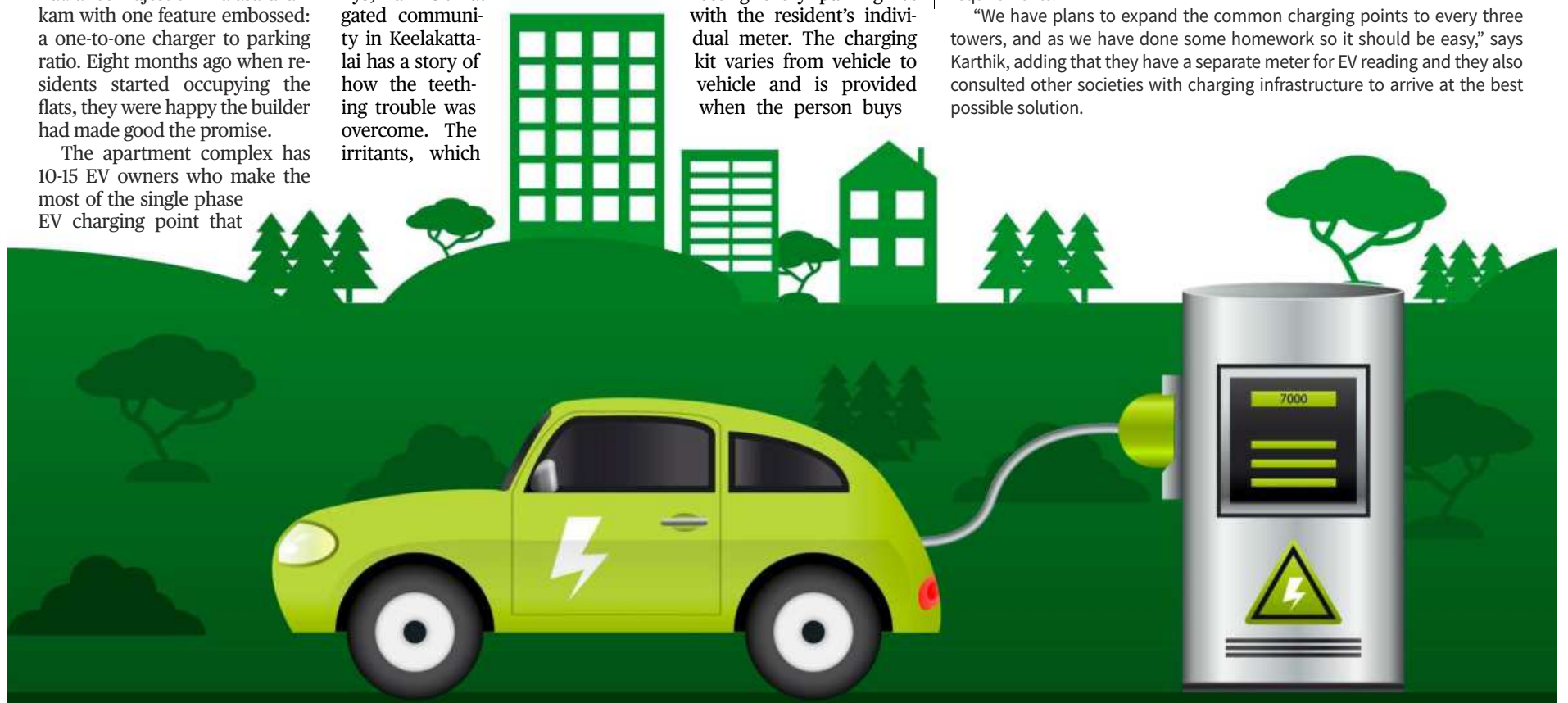
Most older gated communities are not keen on a one-to-one charger to parking ratio for a variety of reasons and are taking baby steps towards increasing the common EV infrastructure.

Brentwood, one of the 13 towers at House of Hiranandani in Egattur, was the first to invest in an EV charging station that was opened to residents from other towers as well. Now, they have another tower, Amalfi, that has also opened a charging station just for cars.

Likewise, DLF Gardencity Cluster 1 in Semmancherry invested in four basic charging devices to meet the needs of both two-and-four wheelers. The infrastructure was installed at a place easily accessible to residents from the nine towers at DLF Gardencity. This year, the Association upgraded the amenity with four charging points for two-wheelers and four others for four-wheelers.

Karthik T.S., a committee member, says their EV journey has been "steady and fruitful". Towards finding out what best suits the needs of the community, they took up a study that included finding out how many vehicles were coming to the community, how quickly the vehicles were getting charged, the EV capacity, the charger that should be used, how many charging stations are there around the campus and the power requirements.

"We have plans to expand the common charging points to every three towers, and as we have done some homework so it should be easy," says Karthik, adding that they have a separate meter for EV reading and they also consulted other societies with charging infrastructure to arrive at the best possible solution.



Inclusive arts to take centre stage at IIT-M on August 2

Can inclusivity be celebrated through art, music and dance? It can - if you were to look at 'Aavaa Dingi', an initiative to empower and develop the underprivileged and economically challenged youth and differently-abled people through workshops, fine arts and cultural performances.

According to a press release, part of the sustainable development project for DCF Global Inclusive Town vision, 'Aavaa Dingi' will witness international inclusive music and dance teams collaborating with local artistes and differently-abled talent to showcase their talent and inspire the world.

After successful drawing/painting and singing competitions earlier this month, the festival heads for a grand celebration on August 2.

The 2026 line-up includes some exciting performances. Apart from inclusive music and dance performances, it will also give away awards in multiple categories.

Columbian singer Evelyn Soto, who regularly tours with AR Rahman, will perform at the event. In addition, the performance will include the inclusive band VFU (Voice for Unity - The DCF Band), comprising 20+ specially talented children, says the press release.

The event will also be supported in person by celebrities

such as popular music composer James Vasanthan, singers Vaikom Vijayalakshmi and Anuradha Sriram.

'Aava Dingi 2026' will take place on August 2, 5 p.m. onwards at Open Air Theatre (OAT), IIT Madras. To register, log on to www.aavaadingi.com



Art against drugs

Fevicryl-certified teachers fan out to educational institutions to create awareness about drug abuse and fight the scourge



BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

A city-wide campaign through art is mobilising students at colleges and schools to speak up about the dangers of substance abuse. Initiated by art and craft brand Fevicryl, the initiative launched recently has Fevicryl-certified teachers visiting institutions

to conduct an art session where students use their creativity to create meaningful works on the theme of drug awareness. The sessions are aimed at encouraging creativity, building teamwork, promoting social responsibility and creating awareness for a drug-free society.

During a workshop at a college in Thiruverkadu.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Tejaswitha Singh, a resident of Adyar who is driving the initiative in south Chennai, says, "All what we ask institutions is give them two hours and at least 200 students and we engage with them to use art to create awareness." The materials for the artworks have to be arranged by the students that includes canvas board, markers and other stationery.

A team of three would be assigned to every institution where they are also involved in colouring a 6ft x 3 ft banner with colourful messages.

Besides being a Fevicryl certified trainer, Tejaswitha works as a guest lecturer in fashion designing. She says there are close to 150 such certified teachers in Chennai and they are fanning out to institutions in their respective areas to increase participation in this initiative.

By researching about drugs and its side effects to send out a message on canvas, the initiative nudges students to recognise behavioural signs and be allies with the State Government in combating the scourge of drug abuse.

If you wish to invite the team, contact Tejaswitha Singh at 80560 91498

Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Youth Welfare Association seeks Amma canteen at Omandurar GH



T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Members of Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Youth Welfare Association in Semmenchery have written a letter to the State government seeking the establishment of an Amma Unavagam (canteen) on the premises of the Tamil Nadu Government Multi Super Speciality Hospital at Omandurar Government Estate.

S. Jayakumar Sekar, a core member of the Association, says, "Every day, the hospital receives many patients and caretakers from various parts of Tamil Nadu. However, there is no affordable food facility within walking distance of the hospital."

It is common to see attenders walking till Wallajah Road and

nearby areas to buy food for patients.

The Amma Unavagam facilities close to the hospital are located approximately 1.5 kilometres away (Arunachalam Road and West Coovam River Road in Chintadripet), making it difficult for those accompanying patients.

Although a restaurant is available at the nearby MLA's Hostel, the prices are beyond the reach of many poor and middle-income families.

The representation was also submitted to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay (Chief Minister's Special Cell), the Health and Family Welfare Department and the hospital administration, requesting establishment of a canteen within the hospital campus, he added.

Inviting married women for 'Face of Chennai'

Registrations have opened for the 15th edition of IRIS Face of Chennai - Mrs Category. Married women up to the age of 50 years from diverse backgrounds can participate to showcase their personality, talents, and unique journeys. Participants will gain

access to expert mentoring, grooming and presentation training, networking opportunities, exciting gifts, and a platform to enhance their confidence and skills.

To register for auditions, contact 98847 83510, 98412 06506



Clear encroachments from service lane

Federation of Radial Road Residents' Associations flags key civic concerns

The Federation of Radial Road Residents' Associations (FORRA) has urged the government to clear encroachments from the service lanes along the Radial Road to ensure the safe and unhindered movement of pedestrians.

At its core committee meeting held recently, FORRA discussed several civic issues raised by residents. Members expressed concern over vehicles being parked on service lanes and called for stricter enforcement to prevent illegal parking and encroachments.

The committee also emphasised the

need to conserve several waterbodies along the corridor, pointing out that many of them are repeatedly choked with water hyacinth. It urged authorities to undertake regular desilting and removal of the invasive weed to restore and protect these waterbodies.

Another issue highlighted at the meeting was the location of a liquor outlet near apartments. Residents expressed concern over the inconvenience and safety issues arising from its proximity to homes, and FORRA urged the government to relocate the wine shop to another place.

Four-week Yoga session from August 3

Satyananda Yoga Centre is conducting a four-week Yoga programme from August 3. According to a press release, no fee will be charged. The centre follows the curriculum and tradition of Bihar School of Yoga. Recitation of mantras and sessions on food habits and moral values are part of the course, adds

the release. Classes will be held in Mamakkam, Madambakkam, Nanganallur, K.K.Nagar and Velachery. Time: From 5.30 a.m. to 7 a.m.

For venue and other details, call 9382577264 / 9500054370 / 9176902929 / 9841227709 / 6383008358 / 8754499334.

Rath Yatra held

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness, Chennai Sri Jagannath Rath Yatra, was held last Sunday.

Devotees and the public participated enthusiastically.

The chariot inauguration ceremony was held at 2:30 p.m. At 3 p.m., the decorated chariot, adorned with Lord Jagannath, Baladeva, and Subhadra Devi, departed near Thangamayil Jewelry in



Chinna Neelankarai and arrived at ISKCON Temple, Injambakkam.

The chariot procession was held with Harinama Sankirtana, Kirtan, and dance.

Guindy terminal needs escalators



Guindy railway station.

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Commuters want Southern Railway to install escalators at the entry point to Guindy terminal from Anna Salai. Currently, pedestrians climb a number of steps to reach the platforms.

S. Ayyappan, a commuter, says, "The commuters have to climb two floors and cross more than 80 steps to go to platforms 1 and 2. At Anna Salai entrance, commuters rush up the steps to board the trains, especially when they see them pull into the station.

There is plenty of space for facilitating escalators,".

The station has the potential to become the fourth terminal, as many passengers book tickets at the ticket counters to board long-distance trains. "At present, a lift connects long-distance trains platforms, but it is yet to be operational. Two escalators connecting the present and yet-to-be-opened footbridge can be facilitated. The yet-to-be-opened bridge should have an entrance along Race Course Road. If an opening is facilitated, there would be diversion of metro and suburban train commuters. Here too, the option of installing escalators should be looked into," says T. Manoharan, a commuter.

The escalators (along Anna Salai) will be useful for long-distance train passengers from Chennai Central and Tambaram railway stations.



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Two-day convention on Vedas

Om Charitable Trust will be hosting its 18th annual two-day convention called "National Vedic Talent Vista 2026." The event will be held on August 1 and 2 at Sri Krishnaswamy hall, No.62, South Boag Road, T. Nagar. Lectures on Vedas, quiz, chanting of Vedas, and cultural events are part of the programme. Phone: 95661 95611 / 91766 91111



During the event. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 57th Montessori teacher training Course in August.

The weekend course will have online and in-person sessions, a format designed to suit working women, enabling them to balance work and family while pursuing their passion for early childhood education.

IMTC-Chennai is affiliated with the Indian Montessori Center, Bengaluru, which awards

the Diploma to successful candidates.

Over the past three decades, IMTC, Chennai, has quietly supported Tamil Nadu's early-education landscape.

IMTC-Chennai has trained more than 1700 teachers, and over 45 schools in Tamil Nadu have been established by the institution's alumni.

For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301.

Email: admissions.imtcc@gmail.com Visit: <https://imtccennai.org>



Investiture ceremony held

Annai Veilankanni's College of Arts & Science organised its investiture ceremony for the academic year 2026-27 recently.

T.S.K. Mayuri, founder of Kalvikkadavul Kamaraj Trust and grand daughter of the former Chief Minister, "Perunthalai-var" K. Kamaraj, was the chief guest.

In her address, she highlighted the essential qualities of a good leadership.

A total of 40 students were invested with badges, and the oath of office was administered.

The event was followed by LAVA 2026, a talent show for first-year students marked by various competitions.

HGI starts school in Padappai

The Hindustan Group of Institutions (HGI) has established Hindustan International School (HIS) in Padappai to provide a contemporary learning environment that integrates academic excellence, technology, creativity, sports, and values-based education.

Theodosius Mar Thoma, Metropolitan, Malankara Mar Thoma Syrian Church, inaugurated the campus.

In his speech, he underscored the importance of education rooted in values, character, and compassion in shaping responsible global citizens.

Anand Jacob Verghese, chairman of Hindustan Group of Institutions, said, "We believe education must go beyond academic achievement to nurture character, creativity,

critical thinking and a sense of purpose. Through this campus, we aim to create an environment where every learner is encouraged to explore their potential, embrace innovation and grow into a responsible global citizen while remaining rooted in strong values."

The campus features smart classrooms, robotics and computer laboratories, composite science laboratories, innovation and maker spaces, and dedicated sports infrastructure.

Two books were released: one curated by Anand Jacob, 'Journey of Parables', a collection of reflections centred on leadership and values, and a coffee table book, 'Historia', documenting the decade-long journey of Hindustan International School, a release from HGI stated.



The team that won the championship. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DG Vaishnav College wins basketball title

The Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College (Autonomous) won the 29th Sree Raghavendra Inter-Collegiate Basketball Championship, held in the city from July 11 to 23.

In the knockout match, the college defeated Jeppiaar University, 72-47; in league matches, SRM University, 67-56; Hindustan University, 71-69; and Madras Christian College, 91-51.

The team showed outstanding teamwork, which paved the way for an unbeaten run in the tournament and helped them to clinch the title and bring pride to the institution.

The results: Hindustan University, runner-up; SRM University, third place; and Madras Christian College, fourth place, said a release.

Workshop on making chocolates



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Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on making chocolates, wafers, and milk shakes on July 30. Another workshop on beekeeping will be held on July 31. According to a press release, prior registration is needed. Both the workshops will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048.

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